

Ross Tax Pro University

Proposed Academic Catalog, Curriculum and Coursebook Resource Plan 2026-2027

****Owner:**** Ross Tax Pro Software Co

****Delivery:**** 100% online, AI-assisted, human-accountable

****Status:**** Curriculum design and readiness artifact - not evidence of accreditation, state authorization, enrollment availability, transferability, or degree-awarding authority.

1. Institutional purpose

Ross Tax Pro University is designed as an access-centered online learning environment grounded in the historic HBCU commitments to intellectual excellence, economic mobility, civic leadership, cultural competence, and community advancement. Its academic method combines rigorous reading, quantitative reasoning, case analysis, writing, practical laboratories, oral defense, and reflective leadership.

The curriculum is original. Texas Southern University materials are used only as public benchmarks for program architecture. No affiliation, endorsement, equivalency, transfer guarantee, or authorization is claimed. Proposed degrees must remain unavailable until every applicable regulator and accreditor confirms authority in writing.

2. Academic quality framework

Every credit-bearing course is designed around 15 instructional-equivalent hours per semester credit hour, plus independent preparation. Each course package must contain:

1. Faculty-approved syllabus and measurable outcomes.
2. Original coursebook or lawfully licensed/open educational resources.
3. Weekly lesson, lecture transcript, accessible slides, guided notes, and glossary.
4. Primary-source reading packet and source annotations.
5. Worked examples, practice set, case or laboratory, and discussion protocol.
6. Low-stakes knowledge checks with feedback.
7. Authentic assessment, scoring rubric, and accessibility alternative.
8. Citation guide, academic-integrity notice, AI-use disclosure, and human appeal route.
9. Version, owner, last review date, next review date, and change log.

AI faculty may explain, demonstrate, tutor, generate practice, and score objective items. Human academic officers approve curricula, subjective grades, appeals, accommodations, integrity decisions, completion, transcripts, and credentials.

3. Stackable pathways

Certificate Level I - Tax Preparation Foundations (18 SCH)

- TAX 1101 Profession and Ethics
- TAX 1301 Individual Taxation I
- TAX 1302 Filing Status and Dependents
- TAX 1303 Income and Adjustments
- TAX 1304 Credits and Due Diligence
- TAX 1205 Practice Laboratory I

****Exit competencies:**** conduct structured intake; distinguish facts from assumptions; research authoritative sources; document due diligence; calculate common individual-return items; protect taxpayer information; and escalate uncertainty. Completion does not confer an IRS credential or authorization to practice.

Certificate Level II - Advanced Tax Practice and Representation (30 SCH)

- TAX 2301 Individual Taxation II
- TAX 2302 Schedule C and Entity Fundamentals
- TAX 2303 Tax Research and Writing
- TAX 2304 IRS Procedure and Notices
- TAX 2305 Transcript Analysis
- TAX 2206 Practice Laboratory II
- TAX 2307 Cybersecurity and Taxpayer Privacy
- TAX 2208 Supervised Capstone

****Exit competencies:**** prepare review-ready research memoranda; organize notice-response evidence; reconcile synthetic transcript events; evaluate business-income records; operate within authority; and build an auditable case file. No course authorizes transcript access, IRS contact, filing, or representation.

Professional Tax Practitioner Diploma (45 SCH)

The diploma stacks both certificate levels with Financial Accounting, Managerial Accounting, Tax Office Operations, a supervised practicum, and capstone. The capstone requires a synthetic client portfolio, source-backed research memorandum, privacy assessment, quality-control review, and oral defense.

4. Proposed associate pathways

Associate of Arts in Business Administration - 60 SCH

The proposed plan combines a general education foundation with the Texas Business Administration Field of Study: financial and managerial accounting, macroeconomics, microeconomics, business principles, business mathematics,

statistics, and business applications. A sample four-term sequence is:

- **Term 1:** Composition I; Business Principles; Business Mathematics; Professional Communication; first-year seminar.
- **Term 2:** Composition II; Macroeconomics; Financial Accounting; United States History I; Creative Arts.
- **Term 3:** Microeconomics; Managerial Accounting; Business Applications; United States History II; Life and Physical Science I.
- **Term 4:** Business Statistics; Federal Government; Texas Government; Life and Physical Science II; Language, Philosophy and Culture; elective.

Associate of Arts in Accounting - 60 SCH

Adds Accounting Information Systems and Payroll Accounting to the business foundation. Students complete a closing-cycle simulation, payroll controls case, spreadsheet model, and ethical-risk memo using synthetic data.

These are proposed degrees. The Texas field-of-study mapping does not itself make courses transferable or authorize the institution to award degrees.

5. Proposed bachelor pathways

All proposed BBA plans total 120 SCH: 42 SCH general education, 24 SCH business field-of-study foundation, 33-39 SCH upper-division school/major work, and electives sufficient to reach 120 SCH. This mirrors the broad architecture publicly reported by established Texas business schools while remaining an original curriculum.

BBA Accounting

Upper-division sequence: Intermediate Accounting I-II; Cost Accounting; Federal Income Taxation; Auditing; Accounting Information Systems; Governmental and Nonprofit Accounting; Advanced Accounting; Financial Management; Organizational Leadership; Marketing; Legal Environment; Operations; advanced electives; Accounting Strategy Capstone.

The program emphasizes source evaluation, internal controls, analytics, ethical judgment, financial reporting, tax research, assurance, and public-interest responsibility. CPA eligibility is jurisdiction-specific and is not promised.

BBA Business Administration

Upper-division sequence: Financial Management; Organizational Leadership; Marketing; Legal Environment; Operations; Business Systems; Entrepreneurship; Strategy; Global Business; Business Analytics; concentration electives; Community Enterprise Capstone.

BBA Management and Human Resources

Specialization: Human Resource Management; Employment Law; Compensation and Benefits; Talent Development; Workforce Analytics; Negotiation; Inclusive Leadership; Workforce Strategy Capstone.

BBA Management Information Systems

Specialization: Systems Analysis; Database Management; Enterprise Applications; Cybersecurity Governance; Cloud Systems; Business Analytics; Responsible AI; Digital Enterprise Capstone.

Future controlled proposals

Finance, Commercial Banking, Marketing, Entrepreneurship, Data Analytics, MBA, Accounting MBA, Healthcare Administration MBA, MIS/Business Analytics MBA, and Executive MBA may be developed only through the same authorization, faculty, library, assessment, and disclosure gates. They are roadmap items, not active programs.

6. Adult education and equivalency

Texas GED Fast-Track

The preparatory sequence covers the four current GED subjects: Reasoning Through Language Arts, Mathematical Reasoning, Science, and Social Studies. The program uses diagnostic placement, individualized study plans, skill lessons, timed practice, readiness conferences, and official-testing referral.

Ross Tax Pro University does not issue the Texas Certificate of High School Equivalency. Texas issues the official credential after qualifying examination. Legacy HiSET and TASC records may appear in state verification systems, but incomplete HiSET testing cannot presently be finished in Texas. Marketing must not call preparation a diploma program.

Adult foundational education

- Reading foundations and vocabulary
- Writing, grammar, and argument
- Numeracy through algebraic reasoning
- Scientific inquiry and data interpretation
- Civic literacy and United States history
- Digital literacy, career exploration, and financial capability
- English-language learner support and accessible alternatives

7. Texas home-education high-school pathway

Texas recognizes bona fide home schools using a written curriculum that includes reading, spelling, grammar, mathematics, and good citizenship. The parent or legal guardian remains the school administrator and diploma authority. The Ross pathway supplies curriculum, records, rubrics, and advising; it must not imply that TEA accredits, approves, or issues a homeschool diploma.

The 22-credit pathway voluntarily uses the Texas Foundation High School Program as a rigor benchmark:

- English language arts: 4 credits
- Mathematics: 3 credits

- Science: 3 credits
- Social studies: 3 credits
- Languages other than English: 2 credits
- Physical education: 1 credit
- Fine arts: 1 credit
- Electives: 5 credits

Good citizenship is integrated through Federal Government, Texas Government, civic action, media literacy, constitutional principles, community responsibility, and respectful public deliberation. Parents retain attendance, portfolio, transcript, course-completion, and diploma records.

8. Coursebook architecture

Each coursebook is authored as eight parts:

1. **Orientation:** essential question, relevance, diagnostic, vocabulary.
2. **Concepts:** concise chapters with sources and counterexamples.
3. **Methods:** worked processes, calculation protocols, research strategies.
4. **Cases:** HBCU-centered entrepreneurship, public service, community wealth, ethics, and technology contexts.
5. **Laboratory:** synthetic documents, spreadsheets, datasets, and simulations.
6. **Seminar:** discussion questions, structured debate, peer response, oral defense.
7. **Assessment:** practice, project, exam, rubric, mastery recovery.
8. **Reference:** glossary, formulas, authorities, bibliography, index, accessibility statement.

Model course: ACCT 2301 Financial Accounting

Outcomes: explain the accounting equation; analyze transactions; prepare adjusting and closing entries; produce and interpret primary financial statements; evaluate internal controls; use spreadsheets; and communicate ethical implications.

Units: accounting as an information system; transaction analysis; accrual accounting; merchandising; cash and internal control; receivables; inventory; long-lived assets; liabilities; equity; cash flows; financial-statement analysis.

Assessments: weekly mastery checks 15%; laboratories 25%; case memoranda 20%; midterm 15%; capstone financial-statement project and oral defense 25%.

Resources: OpenStax *Principles of Financial Accounting* or another faculty-cleared OER; FASB conceptual materials where lawfully accessible; SEC EDGAR public-company filings; original Ross laboratory workbook; spreadsheet templates; accessibility-ready lecture transcripts.

Model course: TAX 2304 IRS Procedure and Notices

****Outcomes:**** classify common notices; identify deadlines; build a chronology; distinguish taxpayer, preparer, and representative authority; retrieve controlling public guidance; draft a review-ready response; and escalate matters outside scope.

****Units:**** administration and authority; taxpayer accounts; notices; examination overview; collection overview; appeals; authorization; records and evidence; penalty framework; identity verification; case closure.

****Resources:**** Internal Revenue Code and Treasury regulations; current IRS publications, forms, instructions, Internal Revenue Manual, Taxpayer Advocate Service materials, and Tax Court opinions. Every lesson requires an as-of date and source check because procedural material changes.

Model course: GED-MATH Mathematical Reasoning

****Outcomes:**** reason with rational numbers; ratios, percentages, and units; solve equations and inequalities; interpret functions; apply geometry; analyze tables and graphs; and explain a solution path.

****Units:**** quantitative fluency; proportional reasoning; algebraic expressions; linear equations; functions; geometry; statistics and probability; multi-step test strategy.

9. Assessment and academic integrity

Objective items may be machine-scored. Essays, projects, oral defenses, appeals, integrity findings, accommodations, and final award decisions require an authorized human. AI-use rules distinguish prohibited substitution from permitted tutoring, brainstorming, feedback, citation support, and accessibility assistance. Students receive notice, evidence, an opportunity to respond, and an appeal route before adverse academic action.

10. Faculty and AI governance

AI Chancellor, Dean, Faculty Instructor, Tutor, Registrar Assistant, Student Success Coach, Instructional Designer, and Assessment Assistant operate from approved knowledge sources, versioned prompts, least privilege, usage limits, redaction, audit correlation, and timeout controls. AI personas do not hold employment, licensure, academic rank, or legal authority. Human officers remain accountable.

11. Required source library

- Current Texas Southern University academic catalog pages for comparative architecture only.
- Texas Higher Education Coordinating Board Texas Core Curriculum and Business Administration Field of Study.
- Texas Education Agency homeschool, Foundation High School Program, and TxCHSE/GED guidance.
- Texas Education Code Chapter 61 degree-authority provisions.
- Current Internal Revenue Code, Treasury regulations, IRS publications/instructions, Internal Revenue Manual, and Taxpayer Advocate Service resources.
- OpenStax business, accounting, mathematics, science, government, and writing texts where appropriate.

• FASB, SEC EDGAR, U.S. Government Publishing Office, Congress.gov, Texas Legislature Online, and court opinions.

Every resource requires license/provenance, edition, URL, retrieval date, accessibility status, course mapping, review owner, and refresh date.

12. Source references

1. Texas Southern University, 2026-2027 Academic Catalog, Jesse H. Jones School of Business and Accounting BBA pages: <https://catalog.tsu.edu/undergraduate/schools-colleges/business/>
2. Texas Higher Education Coordinating Board, Texas Core Curriculum: <https://www.highered.texas.gov/new-program-development/texas-core-curriculum/>
3. Texas Higher Education Coordinating Board, revised Business Administration Field of Study: <https://reportcenter.highered.texas.gov/agency-publication/miscellaneous/business-administration-field-of-study-revised-apr-2023/>
4. Texas Education Agency, Alternative Schooling: <https://tea.texas.gov/families-and-students/finding-school-your-child/alternative-schooling>
5. Texas Education Agency, Foundation High School Program: <https://tea.texas.gov/educators/graduation-information/foundation-high-school-program>
6. Texas Education Agency, Texas Certificate of High School Equivalency/GED: <https://tea.texas.gov/student-readiness-and-high-school/texas-certificate-high-school-equivalency-ged>
7. Texas Education Agency, high-school-equivalency eligibility: <https://tea.texas.gov/student-readiness-and-high-school/certificate-high-school-equivalency/eligibility-requirements-high-school-equivalency-testing>
8. Texas Education Code Chapter 61: <https://statutes.capitol.texas.gov/Docs/ED/htm/ED.61.htm>

13. Publication gate

Before any pathway is marketed as an available degree, diploma, recognized certificate, transferable course, licensure preparation, or accredited program, authorized counsel and academic leadership must verify institutional authority, state authorization, accreditation status, faculty qualifications, library capacity, financial protections, consumer disclosures, catalog terms, complaint processes, records custody, teach-out, accessibility, and truthful advertising.

Academic Operations, Aid, Proctoring and Clearinghouse Blueprint

Control plane

Application intake flows through draft, submission, identity review, document review, academic review, financial review, decision, and enrollment. Every transition is tenant-scoped, idempotent, versioned, audited, and role-authorized. Denial, waitlist, credit evaluation, aid packaging, records correction, withdrawal, and conferment require human decisions.

Financial aid

FAFSA assistance is limited to education and readiness until the institution has documented federal Title IV eligibility and certification. The platform must never promise aid, calculate an official award, use a school code, originate/disburse aid, or exchange federal records before authorization, agreements, security controls, and official identifiers are verified. Student consent, professional judgment, verification, satisfactory academic progress, return-of-funds, reconciliation, and records retention require approved policies and qualified staff.

Texas oversight

Degree programs require an approved institutional authority path. Career/vocational programs require a documented Texas Workforce Commission applicability or exemption determination. Homeschool curriculum support must not be marketed as TEA accreditation. GED preparation must refer learners to the official Texas testing and credential process.

Clearinghouse adapters

Adapters are defined for Enrollment Reporting, DegreeVerify, DiplomaVerify, transcript exchange, and acknowledgement reconciliation. They remain disabled until a signed participation agreement, institution identifiers, secure transport, file specifications, testing certification, reporting calendar, privacy review, designated data owner, and rollback plan exist. Each outbound batch requires validation, hash, human approval, idempotency key, delivery receipt, acknowledgement reconciliation, error queue, and audit event.

Proctoring

Modes are practice, live human, record-and-review, and approved vendor. High-stakes remote proctoring requires identity assurance, informed consent, accommodation handling, privacy impact assessment, retention limits, device/network requirements, incident procedures, human review of flags, appeals, vendor security review, and alternative arrangements. Automated signals cannot independently invalidate an exam or discipline a learner.

Analytics

Dashboards may show application funnel, time in state, document completeness, enrollment yield, course participation, mastery, pacing, retention risk, credits attempted/earned, GPA, satisfactory academic progress status, proctoring review backlog, source freshness, transmission acceptance/rejection, and conferment readiness. Small-cell suppression, tenant boundaries, role filters, and no protected-attribute inference are mandatory.

Production gates

1. Institutional and program authority documented.
2. Accreditation claims reviewed and supported.
3. Database migrations applied to the approved production database.
4. Clerk production authentication and tenant isolation verified.
5. FERPA/privacy/security program approved.
6. Program catalog, refund/cancellation, complaint, teach-out, accessibility, faculty, library, and records policies approved.
7. Title IV functions either officially authorized or technically disabled.
8. Clearinghouse integrations contracted, tested, and certified or disabled.
9. Proctoring vendor and alternatives approved or high-stakes remote proctoring disabled.
10. Synthetic end-to-end tests, monitoring, incident response, and rollback verified.

The current implementation is a fail-closed architecture. It is not evidence that any external authority, accreditor, aid program, clearinghouse, or proctoring provider has approved or connected the institution.

Coursebook Authoring and Resource Standard

Each course release must include a versioned syllabus, 15 instructional-equivalent hours per semester credit hour, measurable outcomes, weekly modules, original or cleared readings, lecture transcript, accessible slides, guided notes, glossary, practice, authentic assessment, rubric, source list, AI-use rules, human appeal route, and faculty approval.

Required metadata

Course code; title; catalog description; credits/contact hours; prerequisites; program mapping; author; human academic owner; AI persona; version; effective term; last source review; next review; accessibility review; copyright/license; retention class; assessment security class.

Lesson package

1. Essential question and relevance.
2. Learning outcomes using observable verbs.
3. Required reading and primary authorities.
4. Original explanation with examples and counterexamples.
5. HBCU-centered community, entrepreneurship, leadership, or public-interest case.
6. Guided practice and answer rationale.
7. Independent application.
8. Formative check and recovery route.
9. Reflection and next-step preview.

Quality gates

- Every legal, tax, accounting, and regulatory claim has a current primary source and as-of date.
- No copied institutional course prose, publisher content, test items, or answer keys.
- No fabricated approvals, accreditation, transfer, licensing, or employment claims.
- AI content receives qualified human review before publication.
- Images have provenance, permission, captions, and alt text.
- Math, tables, and charts have text alternatives.
- Assessment banks are separated from learner-facing packages.
- Course completion cannot automatically issue a consequential credential.